【英语一】 2005 阅读 Text4

基础大纲词 精读补充词 核心重难词
常考大纲短语 核心精读短语 考点长难句

P1 ① Americans **no longer** expect **public figures**, whether in speech or in writing, to command the English language with skill and gift. ② Nor do they **aspire to** such command themselves. ③ In his latest book,

Doing Our Own Thing: The Degradation of Language and Music and Why We Should, Like, Care,

John McWhorter, a linguist and controversialist of mixed liberal and conservative views, sees the triumph of 1960s counter-culture as **responsible for** the decline of formal English.

①美国人不再期待公众人物在讲话或写作中能娴熟而富有天赋地驾驭英语。②他们自己也不追求这样的语言驾驭能力。③约翰·麦克沃特是一位语言学家兼争论家，兼具自由派和保守派的观点。在其新著《自行其是：语言与音乐的退化，以及我们为何应该，呃，在意》中，他把正式英语的衰落归因于20世纪60年代反主流文化的胜利。

P2 ① Blaming the permissive 1960s is nothing new, but this is not **yet another** criticism against the decline in education. ② Mr. McWhorter's academic speciality is language history and change, and he sees the gradual disappearance of "whom," **for example**, to be natural and **no more** regrettable **than** the loss of the case-endings of **Old English**.

①指责放任自由的20世纪60年代并不新鲜，但本书并不是又一部抨击教育衰退的批评之作。②麦克沃特先生的学术专长是语言的历史与演变。例如，他认为“whom”一词的逐渐消失是自然现象，其可惜程度不亚于古英语格尾的消失。

P3 ① But the cult of the authentic and the personal, "doing our own thing," has spelt the death of formal speech, writing, poetry and music. ② While even the modestly educated sought an elevated tone when they **put pen to paper** before the 1960s, even the most well regarded writing since then has **sought to** capture **spoken English on the page**. ③ Equally, in poetry, the highly personal, **performative genre** is the only form that could claim real liveliness. ④ In **both** oral **and written English**, talking is **triumphing over** speaking, spontaneity over craft.

①但对本真和个性的推崇，即“自行其是”，已使正式的口语、书面语、诗歌和音乐走向消亡。②20世纪60年代之前，即便是受过一般教育的人，一提笔写作也会追求一种高雅的格调；而此后，即便是最受推崇的作品，也力图在纸面上呈现口语化的英语。③同样，在诗歌领域，高度个人化、表演性的体裁是唯一称得上有真正生命力的形式。④无论口语英语还是书面英语，随意闲谈都在压倒正式表达，即兴发挥都在压倒精心雕琢。

P4 ① **Illustrated with an** entertaining **array of** examples from **both** high **and** low culture, the trend that Mr. McWhorter documents is unmistakable. ② But it is less clear, to take the question of his subtitle, why we should, like, care. ③ As a linguist, he acknowledges that **all varieties of** human language, including non-standard ones like **Black English**, can be powerfully expressive—there exists no language or dialect in the world that cannot convey complex ideas. ④ He is not arguing, as many do, that we can **no longer** think straight because we do not talk proper.

①麦克沃特先生列举了一系列取自高雅文化与通俗文化的生动有趣的实例作为佐证，他所记述的这一趋势确凿无疑。②但回到他副标题所提出的问题：我们为何应该，呃，在意，这一点就不那么明晰了。③作为一名语言学家，他承认人类的各种语言，包括黑人英语等非标准语言，都可以极富表现力——世界上不存在任何一种无法表达复杂思想的语言或方言。④他并不像许多人那样主张：我们之所以不再能清晰地思考，是因为我们讲话不够规范。

P5 ① Russians have a deep love for their own language and carry **large chunks of** memorized poetry in their heads, while Italian politicians **tend to** elaborate speech that would seem old-fashioned to most English-speakers. ② Mr. McWhorter acknowledges that **formal language** is not strictly necessary, and proposes no radical education reforms— he is really **grieving over** the loss of something beautiful **more than** useful. ③ We now take our English "on paper plates **instead of** china." ④ A shame, perhaps, but probably an inevitable one.

①俄罗斯人深爱自己的语言，脑中能背诵大段大段的诗歌；意大利政客则习惯于精雕细琢的演讲，这种风格在大多数英语使用者看来会显得过于陈旧。②麦克沃特先生承认，正式语言并非绝对必要，也未提出任何激进的教育改革方案——他真正哀叹的是一种美的丧失，而非实用价值的丧失。③如今，我们用“纸盘”而非“瓷盘”来盛放我们的英语。④这或许令人遗憾，但很可能也是无可避免的。

Q1. **According to** McWhorter, the decline of formal English____. 细节题

[A] is inevitable in radical education reforms

[B] is but **all too** natural in language development

[C] has caused the controversy over the counter-culture

[D] **brought about** changes in public attitudes in the 1960s

麦克沃特认为，正式英语的衰落____。

A.在彻底的教育改革中是不可避免的

B.是语言发展过程中再自然不过的事情

C.引起了对反文化运动的争议

D.引起了20世纪60年代公众态度的变化

Q2. The word "talking" (Para. 3) denotes_____. 词句理解题

[A] modesty

[B] personality

[C] liveliness

[D] informality

单词“talking”(第3段)表示_____。

A.谦虚

B.个性

C.生动

D.非正式

Q3. **To** which of the following statements would McWhorter most likely **agree**? 细节题

[A] Logical thinking is not necessarily **related to** the way we talk.

[B] Black English can be more expressive than standard English.

[C] Non-standard **varieties of** human language are just as entertaining.

[D] Of all the varieties, standard English can best convey complex ideas.

麦克沃特最可能同意下列哪一种说法?

A.逻辑思维和我们说话方式不一定相关。

B.黑人英语比标准英语更具表现力。

C.各种各样非标准的人类语言同样有趣。

D.在所有种类的语言中，标准英语最能传达复杂的思想。

Q4. The description of Russians' love of memorizing poetry shows the author's_____. 例证题

[A] interest in their language

[B] appreciation of their efforts

[C] admiration for their memory

[D] contempt for their old-fashionedness

关于俄罗斯人喜欢背诵诗歌的描述，可见作者的_____。

A.对他们的语言感兴趣

B.对他们所做努力的赞赏

C.对他们记忆力的钦佩

D.对他们过时行为的鄙视

Q5. **According to** the last paragraph, "paper plates" is to "china" as____. 推理题

[A] "temporary" is to "permanent"

[B] "radical" is to "conservative"

[C] "functional" is to "artistic"

[D] "humble" is to "noble"

根据最后一段，“纸盘子”之于“瓷器”相当于____。

A.“暂时的”之于“永恒的”

B.“激进的”之于“保守的”

C.“实用的”之于“艺术的”

D.“卑微的”之于“高贵的”